



the basic
argument



**allowable
evils**

A large, solid orange circle serves as the background for the text.

what is
omnipotence?

the
argument
reformulated

We have seen that there is reason to doubt premise (5) of Mackie's argument. But the counterexamples to premise (5) we have considered suggest a way to repair the argument.

Every case in which it seemed like a being could legitimately allow some evil to exist was one in which the evil was outweighed by some good which the being could not bring about without the evil. That suggests that the following claim is plausible:

Our examples of parents and dentists cast no doubt on (5^*) .

Indeed, if anything, they support it.

5. If something is wholly good, it always eliminates as much evil as it can.

5*. If something is wholly good, it always eliminates as much pointless evil as it can.

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Mackie's argument. But the counterexample to premise (5) we

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5. If something is wholly

good, it always ends

as in the first case.



5*. If something is wholly

as much points as

good, it always ends

in can. in.



any possible

is important, it



2: If something

cairibiriing about



1. If God exists, then God is

4. If God exists, then God is

it always initiates as much

prints even as it can.

5*. If something is wholly good,

it can do anything.

6. If God exists, then God

evaluates God's air. (4,5)

do anything. (1,2)

elinites all point less vii.

elinitates nich printess

2. If something is on it,

wholly good.

9*. Some principles exist.

C. God does not exist. (8,9)

3. If God exists, then God can

(3,6)

7. If God exists, then God

8. If God exists, then there is

no point less evi1. (7)



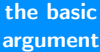


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There are two especially important arguments against belief in God.



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evildoers.

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So attention naturally focuses on premise (5).



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